



Son Abhishek after graduation

helped Satya and his team bag the award of Best Silicon Design team from EE-Times. Notably, this is just one of the many awards OpenSilicon, under Satya's leadership, won for its remarkable work.

After working on OpenSilicon for more than four years, the company was acquired in 2007 for \$245 million, marking it as one of the biggest exits in the chip industry.

Satya went on to start two more ventures—Concept2Silicon and SenZopt Technologies. While Concept2Silicon had a similar idea as OpenSilicon, which was to design ARM-based chips, it was acquired by HCL Technologies. SenZopt dealt with sensors and IoT solutions for automating buildings and turning them into smart buildings.

Satya's association with Intel, however, was far from finished. "I have worked with Intel for one project or the other in every startup of mine," he says. Even though he held the senior-most position in his ventures, Satya is someone who does not shy away from doing the dirty work, and quite literally so.

In 2008, Intel wanted to build a fully automated parking facility in Bangalore and SenZopt

was roped in to handle the work.

"We had to install the sensors at a multi-storey parking lot while the construction was going on, and for 3 months, along with my co-founder Chitra Hariharan, we worked in that dust and rubble for 16 hours, doing the installation and completing work in time."

Such is Satya's commitment to work! But Satya humbly adds, "The commitment is needed but more than that, the willingness to get down in the trenches and do it is what is very important."

In 2019, SenZopt was acquired. Parting with a startup as a founder is undoubtedly one of the toughest things to do. It is like your baby, but Satya believes that as long as it does good, it does not matter whose hands it is in. "Just like your child

needs to go out and learn from others to grow, a startup acquisition is a push for that idea to blossom which you began it with. It is not the money that matters, pursuing an idea does."

Building the core of India's electronics industry

Satya's love for his work translated into doing something big, but he was not satisfied with those efforts. He wanted to help propel India as one of the global leaders in electronics and semiconductors, which he slowly started doing.

Satya says, "When I moved to India, after a couple of years we felt that there was no platform for semiconductor companies in India. So, a few of us got together and started the Indian Semiconductor Association." This association grew on to become the Indian Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA), one of the biggest industry associations in the electronics industry. "We realised that electronics cannot work without semiconductors which is why we changed it to IESA."

Satya is currently the President of the VLSI Society of India, an association helping to grow Indian R&D and talent in semiconductors and chip design. Many of these efforts of Satya and others, right from the early 2000s, have resulted in the India Semiconductor Mission—a mission aiming to make India grab a seat at the global chip design and manufacturing table.

But building a strong chip ecosystem is not enough. "Products drive manufacturing rather than manufacturing driving products." With this in mind, Satya along with two HCL founders, Ajai Chowdhry and Arjun Malhotra, began the EPIC Foundation—a consortium of leaders aiming to drive electronics product development in India and build Indian brands.

Satya makes sure to not let his

Some Unknown Facts About Dr Satya Gupta

Favourite Singer	: Kishor Kumar
Favourite Actress	: Madhubala
Favourite Actor	: Rajesh Khanna, Anupam Kher
Favourite Leader	: Narendra Modi, Andy Grove
Favourite Cuisine	: Indian
Favourite Book	: Premchand, Harry Potter
Favourite Movie	: Guide, the original Jungle Book
Favourite Sport	: Cricket
Favourite Bike	: Royal Enfield Classic-350